If you were to run this code in a web browser, it would fail because setting the `withCredentials` property to `true` isn't enough to complete the request. The server must also indicate that it allows cookies for the request to succeed. Chapter 5 will delve deeper into how the server can enable cookies on requests.

NOTE The `withCredentials` property doesn't work with synchronous requests.

This section covered the basics of using the `XMLHttpRequest` object in the context of cross-origin requests. You can use the techniques from this section to make cross-origin requests to a CORS-enabled server. If you'd like to learn more about how the `XMLHttpRequest` object works, you can turn to *Ajax in Practice* by Dave Crane et al. (Manning, 2007), or go directly to the `XMLHttpRequest` spec at http://xhr.spec.whatwg.org/.

While the `XMLHttpRequest` object allows you to make cross-origin requests from most browsers, Internet Explorer 8 and Internet Explorer 9 support a limited set of cross-origin requests. These browsers use a different object, called `XDomainRequest`, to make these requests. The next section looks into how the `XDomainRequest` works and how it's different from the `XMLHttpRequest` object.

2.4 XDomainRequest object in Internet Explorer 8 and 9

Internet Explorer 8 and Internet Explorer 9 support cross-origin requests, but in a different way. These browsers still have an `XMLHttpRequest` object for making same-origin requests, but they also have a different `XDomainRequest` object specifically for making cross-origin requests. This `XDomainRequest` object is only relevant to Internet Explorer 8 and Internet Explorer 9. Internet Explorer 10 and above support the regular `XMLHttpRequest` object for both same-origin and cross-origin requests. If CORS support for Internet Explorer 8 and Internet Explorer 9 is important to you, you'll want to learn the details of how the `XDomainRequest` object works.

Listing 2.6 changes the Flickr API example to use the `XDomainRequest` object. The `XDomainRequest` object looks a lot like an `XMLHttpRequest` object. If you compare this listing to the original code, there is only a one-line difference when creating a new `XDomainRequest` object ❶. Once you have a new `XDomainRequest` object, you can use it in the same way you use the `XMLHttpRequest` object. You can use the `send` method to send the request, and then use the `onload` and `onerror` event handlers to process the response.

Listing 2.6 Using the `XDomainRequest` object to make a request to the Flickr API

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body onload="loadPhotos();">
<div id="photos">Loading photos...</div>
<script>
function loadPhotos() {
  var method = 'GET';
  var url = 'http://s3.amazonaws.com/corsinaction/flickr.json';
  var xhr = new XDomainRequest();      <-- 1
  xhr.open(method, url);
```